



How fossils are made

A lot of things need to happen for an animal or plant to become a fossil. It also takes **millions of years**. Here's what happens.

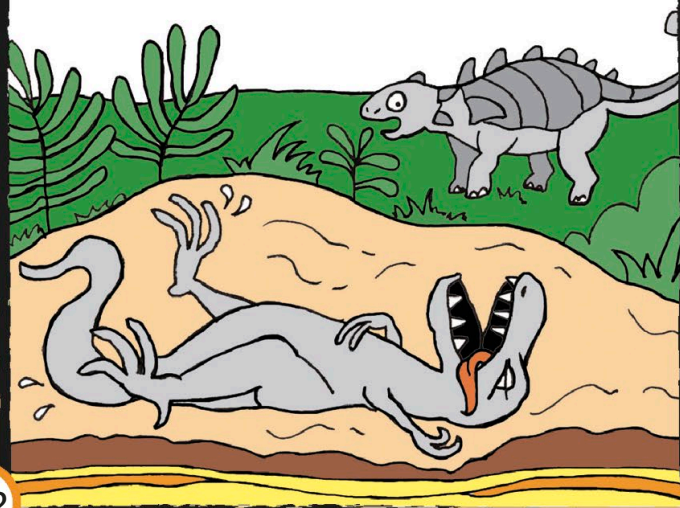
Some fossils have been found that are more than 3 billion years old!



Fossilization

Fossils only form if an animal or plant is **buried** quickly after death. Otherwise it will just decay and disappear. This is why fossils are so rare.

1 A dinosaur dies and becomes **buried** in thick mud.



2 Over a few years the flesh rots away, leaving just the **bones**.

